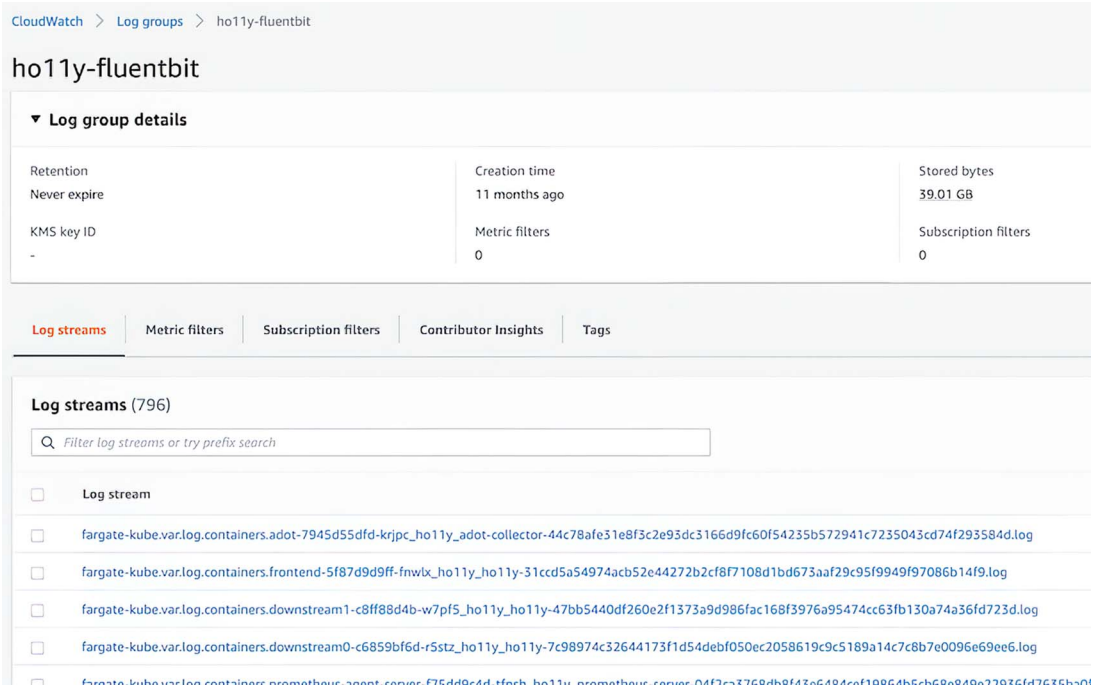


Figure 3.3 Consuming Kubernetes application-level logs in the CloudWatch console

journald. Here, it's most important to consider whether to use a managed service or run Kubernetes yourself.

For managed services, the control plane logs are of a more informational nature, since you typically don't have access to the control components (potentially useful when interacting with the cloud provider support team):

- In Amazon EKS, control plane logs (http://mng.bz/BmOv) are configurable and land in CloudWatch by default.
- In Azure AKS, several resource logs (http://mng.bz/d1gD) for control plane components are available.
- In Google GKE, you can manage both system and app logs (http://mng.bz/rWNg), with the former including control plane components.

Audit logs (http://mng.bz/V1ZX) are another source of logs in Kubernetes, capturing user-generated activities as well as control plane–related ones. These audit logs provide a detailed record of who issued each change as well as in-cluster authentication events and are often relevant, or even required, for regulated workloads and environments.

For metrics, Kubernetes uses the Prometheus exposition format (http://mng.bz/x4V8) to emit metrics, defined in the metrics pipeline (http://mng.bz/Aopp), which is part of the control plane. In contrast to logs, the definition and management